

of 1,256 in the Single-Core test and 4,093 in the Multi-Core Test – placing it among the top contenders in its price segment. The PCMark Work score of 14,573 is equally impressive. I also ran the CPU Throttling Test to assess sustained performance under load which revealed that the phone only throttled to 83 percent of its peak performance. However, the phone does not run GPU benchmarks such as 3D Mark and GFXBench, a common occurrence with Xiaomi and POCO phones.

As expected, the phone excels in real-world gaming tests. Titles like Call of Duty: Mobile, Pokemon Unite, and BGMI run seamlessly even at the highest graphics settings, with no signs of lag or stuttering, and the device remains cool during extended gaming sessions. In everyday tasks, the phone effortlessly handles navigation, thanks to the 120 Hz refresh rate support. The only drawback is the presence of bloatware.

The POCO X6 Pro introduces Xiaomi's new HyperOS out of the box. It also runs Android 14. This software is fluid, feature-rich, and user-friendly. However, the persisting issue is the bloatware. Upon booting up the device, users are greeted with nine preinstalled games and numerous third-party apps. Although most of these can be uninstalled, such practices are not welcome in 2024. I POCO addresses this concern in future releases.

On a positive note, there is an improvement in OS support. POCO has extended the update commitment, promising three years of OS updates and four years of security updates – an excellent move forward.

CAMERA

It's not just the performance that has taken a leap forward, the POCO X6 Pro also features an improved primary camera. Although, the numbers have gone down on paper – from 108-megapixels to 64-megapixels, the camera is substantially better and comes equipped with Optical Image Stabilisation (OIS). The phone houses a

64-megapixel primary camera with OIS, an 8-megapixel ultrawide shooter, and a 2-megapixel macro camera. On the front, there's a 16-megapixel selfie shooter as well. Video recording is capped with 4K at 30 fps on the rear camera, and the phone supports gyro-EIS for stabilisation.

In daylight conditions, the primary camera captures commendable photos. Colors remain close to natural, although there's a tendency to wash out human subjects and smoothen skin textures. While detail retention is solid, the dynamic range falls short as shadows are underexposed. Nonetheless, the photos are suitable for social media posting, exhibiting a natural look without excessive oversharpening.

Portrait images are pleasing, with slight face washout but excellent edge detection and portrait blur for the price. Unfortunately, consistency is an issue; the portrait blur effect doesn't apply if light levels dip below a certain threshold. I tried multiple times; even tried applying bokeh post clicking the picture in HyperOS' new photo editor, but it didn't work. The phone is just not capturing portrait data in low light. We hope that POCO can fix this via an OTA update.

The 8-megapixel ultrawide camera delivers decent performance in daylight, though corners lack sharpness. Macro photography excels, capturing intricate details effectively.

Transitioning to low-light photography, the phone encounters challenges. While an improvement over the POCO X5 Pro, there's still some noise and haziness. Selfie photos, under optimal lighting conditions, exhibit good color and detail. However, in challenging lighting situations, the photos tend to become soft and blurry.

BATTERY LIFE

The POCO X6 Pro 5G keeps the lights on with a 5,000 mAh battery. The battery life is pretty decent; it can last over a day if you're a light user. However, if you're someone who games heavily, the phone will require a top-up in the

evening. In our 4K video loop test, the POCO X6 Pro lasted for over 14 hours from a full battery to empty.

Using Google Maps for an hour drained the battery by 5 percent, while playing Call of Duty: Mobile for 15 minutes drained another 4 percent. These are pretty decent numbers and match up to most of its competition. The phone comes with 67W fast charging, which topped off our review unit from an empty battery to full in merely 49 minutes.

VERDICT

The POCO X6 Pro 5G deserves to be crowned the value king in the sub-₹30,000 price segment. Starting at a competitive price of ₹26,999, the POCO X6 Pro 5G offers flagship-grade performance with impressive cooling, Android 14 and HyperOS out of the box, a decent build, and an improved camera. It butts heads with more expensive offerings in the market such as the iQOO Neo 7 Pro and provides comparable performance on a discount. The phone is not perfect though – the non-leather variants attract fingerprints, the bloatware issue is rampant, and the portrait camera is a bit of a hit-or-miss, but most of these are minor issues in the grand scheme of things. If you're looking for unbridled performance without burning a hole in your pocket, the POCO X6 Pro 5G is one of the best options you consider.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Dimensity 8300 Ultra | GPU: Mali G615-MC6 | RAM: Up to 12 GB LPDDR5X | ROM: Up to 512 GB UFS 4.0 | Cooling: 5000 mm² VC cooling system | Colours: Spectre Black, Racing Grey, POCO Yellow | Display: 6.67-inch AMOLED 1.5K resolution, 68 B colours, 120 Hz refresh rate | Display Technology: Dolby Vision, HDR10+, Adaptive HDR | Rear Cameras: 64 MP wide (OIS) + 8 MP ultrawide + 2 MP macro | Selfie Camera: 16 MP | OS: Android 14, HyperOS | Battery Capacity: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 67 W

CONTACT

Company: POCO | Phone: 1800-572-7626 | Email: service.in@poco.net | Website: <https://www.poco.in/>